

3. JOBS PUSH

Big-ticket projects such as Vedanta-Foxconn semiconductor plant and Tata-Airbus aircraft manufacturing unit have landed in the state. With its Atmanirbhar Gujarat push, the BJP has promised to create 1.5 million jobs

4. COOPERATIVE CAPTURE

The BJP wants to leverage its increasing control over cooperatives. Union home minister **Amit Shah** was given the charge of the new cooperation ministry in July 2021 as part of this strategy





5. WOO THE PATIDARS

Bhupendra Patel is the CM face, and 25% BJP candidates are Patidars. After Hardik Patel's crossover, the apex court's stamp on EWS quota—the genesis of which lies in the 2015 Patidar movement—has given the BJP a boost

6. THE HINDUTVA BACKDROP

The remission of sentence and hero's welcome given to the 11 men convicted in a 2002 gang-rape and murder case has brought the BJP's Hindutva agenda back to the centre stage, apparently to retain the loyalty of a section of voters



7. VINDICATION IN RIOTS CASE

The Supreme Court's decision upholding the clean chit to Modi in the **2002 Gujarat riots** has bolstered the BJP's narrative that the then CM was a victim, and not the perpetrator, of a conspiracy

8. CAMPAIGNER -IN-CHIEF

In five visits to the state since Aug., thrice in Oct. alone, the PM announced projects and schemes worth Rs 79,000 cr. before the model code was imposed. With Amit Shah, he is micromanaging the BJP's election campaign too

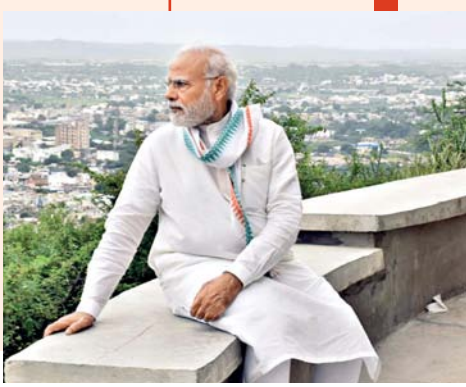


9. COUNTER AAP SOPS

Facing anti-incumbency, the BJP is projecting its 27-year rule as a sign of electorate's trust in it while branding challengers like Kejriwal 'untrustworthy' and his party's promise of freebies as '*revdis*'

10. INVOKE GUJARATI PRIDE

With the slogan *'Aa Gujarat Mai Banavyu Chhe'* ('I have made this Gujarat'), Modi has masterfully invoked Gujarati *asmita*—an old political ploy in the state—while linking himself with this pride in identity



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rise and unemployment, exacerbated by the Covid-19 pandemic and an underperforming national economy. The third was to defang and neutralise the Congress, which had surprised the BJP with its spirited campaign in 2017 that saw it secure 77 seats, the highest ever since the BJP came to power in 1995. The fourth was the need to meet the aspirations of the various caste groups and assuage any feelings of neglect or bias, particularly among the Patidars, whose revolt in 2017 against the BJP gave wind to the Congress sails. The fifth was the rising challenge posed by AAP and its convenor Kejriwal, particularly its brand of what Modi labelled the '*revdi* culture' of doling out enormous amounts of freebies to woo voters. The AAP challenge could prove a double-edged sword. By splitting the Opposition vote, it could help the BJP garner a greater number of seats. But it could also emerge as a significant force in the process and become a true contender for power by the subsequent state elections in 2027.

For the election this year, Modi set the wheels of the BJP's grand strategy to retain Gujarat into motion way back in July 2021. The first step was to use a Union cabinet rejig to woo the OBC (Other Backward Classes) voters in the state, who at 37 per cent form the largest chunk of the state's population and influence the outcome in 90 seats. So, OBC